

Set Up a Mail Server With iRedMail

Setting up a mail server takes a long time and requires some configuration. And if you want to set up another mail server at a later point of time, you'll have to go through the same procedure all over again. With iRedMail that's no longer the case. Setting up a mail server can't be easier or more hassle-free than with iRedMail.



Basically, iRedMail is a script to automate the installation and configuration of a mail server with built-in anti-spam and anti-virus protection. You can get the latest version of iRedMail from <http://www.iredmail.org/>. At present, it supports a number of operating systems including Red Hat Enterprise Linux, CentOS, Scientific Linux, Debian, Ubuntu, Gentoo, openSUSE, and FreeBSD. Here, we'll deploy it on a RHEL5 machine.

Download iRedMail and extract it. You'll see a script file named *iRedMail.sh*. All you need to do is to run this file. Make sure your local *Yum* repository is properly configured because the *dialogue* package will be required before you start the installation process. Also make sure you're connected to the Internet because a number of packages need to be downloaded. If all goes well, then upon running the script, you'll see the start-up screen shown in Figure 1.

Once you select 'Yes', the installation process starts and you'll have to configure a few settings. The two notable ones are selecting your 'Virtual Domain', which should not be the same as your server hostname, and selecting the backend to store your mail accounts (MySQL or LDAP). Once the configuration is complete, you will be asked to continue. All the desired packages will get installed. This will take some time, so if you wish you can take a short break.

If you have 'Sendmail' installed, then once all the packages are installed, you'll be asked to remove it. A few more 'Yes/No' type questions and your set-up will be complete. At the end of the set-up process, you'll see a few links for webmail and the admin panel, which will be <https://www.yourservername/mail> and <https://www.yourservername/iredadmin>, respectively. You'll also see the details of account postmaster@yourdomainname and its password. At the end

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